

A close-up photograph of a glass filled with iced tea and lemon slices. The glass is tall and has a textured, ribbed design. The tea is a pale yellow color, and there are several ice cubes floating on top. A slice of lemon is visible, partially submerged in the tea. The background is dark and out of focus.

SPECIALTY TEAS ARE TAKING OVER MORE AND MORE SHELF SPACE IN THE SUPERMARKETS

GOOD HEALTH IN A CUP

Tea has long been consumed for its health properties, but the wealth of new research on tea is highlighting more health benefits than the original tea pioneers could ever have imagined. Green tea, with its “health halo,” is now so popular that it is being grown in countries that didn’t traditionally produce it, such as India and Sri Lanka, to keep up with world demand.

TEA ON THE GO

Ready-to-drink bottled tea is a great “grab and go” option, and is available in numerous stores, cafés, and vending machines. Available au naturel or with the addition of fruit, gelled coconut, and other interesting ingredients, bottled tea is becoming more popular than ever.

BUBBLE TEA

Colorful and tasty, bubble tea (see p192) has taken the world by storm since it first appeared in Taiwan in the 1980s. Everything about it, from the oversized straws used to drink the tea to the chewy tapioca boba (the bubbles at the bottom) bursting with flavor, makes it a fun experience.

BEST SERVED CHILLED

Extracting more natural sweetness than hot tea, and with less caffeine, cold infusion (see pp58–59), or infusing leaves using cold water, is a growing trend. There is a wide variety of equipment available, from easy-to-use infusers to more elaborate teaware, to help you make and enjoy these chilled teas.